

Time Of Use Tariffs

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Time-of-Use (TOU) Tariffs

Under a Time-of-Use tariff, the price of electricity changes depending on the time of day. Off-peak rates are the cheapest, usually occurring overnight. Peak rates are the most expensive, often from 4 PM to 9 PM. Mid-peak rates apply during the remaining hours. Knowing your TOU schedule allows you to run heavy loads, such as electric vehicle charging or dishwashers, during off-peak windows, drastically reducing your monthly bill.

Solar's Role in Time-of-Use (TOU):

A solar energy system is the most effective tool to combat expensive Time-of-Use tariffs. Typically, peak utility rates occur in the late afternoon and early evening when solar production is ramping down. By orienting some solar panels westward, homeowners can extend their solar generation into the late afternoon, directly offsetting the most expensive grid electricity. When paired with a battery, TOU tariffs can be completely avoided by charging from solar in the morning and discharging during the expensive evening peak.

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